DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

1. SYSTEM OVERVIEW

The platform is implemented as a transaction authority system configured to govern the formation, validation, execution, and lifecycle control of financed transactions. As shown in FIG. 1, the platform may be accessed by seller or dealer interfaces, financing-participant interfaces, general capture devices, and optional dedicated capture devices. The platform may be cloud-hosted, distributed, or hybrid, and may include or coordinate multiple engines, including but not limited to:

- **Intake Engine**
- **Form Synthesis Engine**
- **Candidate Evaluation Engine**
- **Requirement Satisfaction Engine**
- **Financing-Participant Validation Engine**
- **State Machine Engine**
- **Capture Integrity Engine**
- **Source Lock Engine**
- **Authoritative Embodiment Engine**
- **Support Record Engine**
- **Post-Funding Compliance Engine**
- **Participant Review Engine**
- **Evidentiary and Package Generation Engine**
- **Operational Reporting and Analytics Engine**
- **Workflow Self-Evaluation Engine**

These engines may be implemented as software modules, microservices, distributed components, or integrated subsystems. Functions may be combined, separated, or executed in parallel depending on system configuration.

The system is designed to ensure that a single governing agreement is formed, validated, executed, preserved, and used as the authoritative basis for all downstream operations, while all support records, approvals, and lifecycle events remain linked to the same transaction authority file.

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2. SYSTEM START TRIGGER

The system initiates upon execution or acknowledgment of a pre-transaction disclosure. This disclosure informs the customer and seller that:

- preliminary physical documents may be used in connection with financing acceptance;
- the governing agreement will not be executed until the platform approves the transaction;
- physical documents will be converted into electronic records;
- the platform will govern the formation and validation of the governing agreement.

This disclosure event creates or activates the transaction profile and establishes the platform as the controlling authority for the transaction lifecycle.

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3. INTAKE, CONFIGURATION, AND JURISDICTION-SPECIFIC DEAL FORMATION

The **Intake Engine** collects transaction parameters including:

- seller identity
- financing-participant identity
- jurisdiction
- collateral information
- customer information
- ancillary-product selections
- program-specific requirements
- filing parameters
- timing rules
- role assignments
- workflow restrictions

Using these inputs, the **Form Synthesis Engine** generates a transaction-specific deal environment. This environment may include:

- jurisdiction-specific forms
- disclosures
- requirement categories
- fee rules
- timing rules
- approval conditions
- workflow instructions
- a candidate governing contract instrument

The system ensures that the deal environment is tailored to the jurisdiction, program, and participant requirements applicable to the transaction.

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4. CANDIDATE GOVERNING CONTRACT INSTRUMENT

The platform generates an unsigned **candidate governing contract instrument** corresponding to the form intended to become the governing agreement if approved for execution.

This candidate instrument:

- is version-controlled from the moment of generation;
- is evaluated before execution;
- may be regenerated if material changes occur;
- is used to determine requirement sufficiency and approval readiness;
- is the basis for pre-execution validation.

The candidate instrument is not executable until the platform authorizes execution.

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5. PRE-EXECUTION EVALUATION

The **Candidate Evaluation Engine** evaluates the candidate governing contract instrument and surrounding data for:

- jurisdiction-specific compliance
- fee accuracy
- collateral sufficiency
- customer eligibility
- requirement category completeness
- document equivalency
- timing compliance
- financing-participant criteria
- program-specific rules
- risk indicators

If deficiencies are detected, the system assigns the transaction to a conditional state and generates a **Completion Protocol** identifying the items required for advancement.

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6. TRANSACTION STATE MACHINE

The platform uses a controlled, multi-stage **state machine** to govern transaction progression. States may include:

- **Red** — not approvable
- **Yellow** — conditionally approvable but not executable
- **Green Stage One** — execution and funding authorized
- **Green Stage Two** — post-funding clearance achieved

Each state transition requires satisfaction of specific conditions. The system does not require tasks to be completed in strict chronological order, but it enforces that all conditions applicable to a transition must be satisfied before advancement occurs.

The state machine ensures that:

- execution cannot occur prematurely;
- funding cannot occur without execution validation;
- post-funding obligations must be completed before final clearance;
- all participants operate within their authority boundaries.

7. COMPLETION PROTOCOL

The platform generates a **Completion Protocol** whenever a transaction is in a conditional state. The Completion Protocol is a machine-generated, transaction-specific list of:

- required documents,
- required proofs,
- required approvals,
- required confirmations,
- required data corrections,
- required timing conditions, and
- any prerequisite workflow steps.

The Completion Protocol may include requirement categories such as:

- identity verification
- collateral verification
- income or employment verification
- ancillary-product documentation
- jurisdiction-specific disclosures
- filing-related prerequisites
- assignment-supporting documentation
- lien-supporting documentation

- risk-based supplemental requirements

The platform updates the Completion Protocol dynamically as new information is added, deficiencies are resolved, or new conditions arise. The system may also generate alerts, readiness indicators, or workflow instructions to guide participants toward satisfying the protocol.

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8. REQUIREMENT SATISFACTION AND DOCUMENT EQUIVALENCY

The platform evaluates requirement categories using a **Document Equivalency Matrix**, which defines:

- primary documents that satisfy a requirement category;
- substitute documents that may satisfy the requirement;
- substitute document sets that collectively satisfy the requirement;
- conditions under which substitutes are acceptable;
- whether financing-participant approval is required for substitutes;
- whether timing rules affect acceptance.

For example, a requirement category for collateral verification may be satisfied by:

- a primary document such as a manufacturer's certificate of origin;
- a substitute document such as a title application;
- a substitute document set such as a bill of sale plus a lien release.

The platform ensures that requirement categories are satisfied before allowing state transitions. If a document does not match expected parameters, the system may generate a discrepancy state requiring correction or override.

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9. ROLE-BASED VISIBILITY AND SEGMENTED WORKFLOW

The platform enforces **role-based workflow segmentation**, ensuring that each participant only sees and performs actions appropriate to their authority. Roles may include:

- seller or dealer personnel
- financing-participant underwriters
- financing-participant funders

- administrative personnel
- auditors
- legal reviewers
- system administrators

Each role may have restricted visibility into:

- governing agreement content
- support records
- approval paths
- override options
- discrepancy details
- workflow controls
- state transition authority

This segmentation ensures compliance, reduces risk, and prevents unauthorized actions. It also allows financing participants to maintain control over approval, override, and exception handling.

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10. FINANCING-PARTICIPANT VALIDATION AND DIFFERENTIAL AUTHORITY

The platform supports **Financing-Participant Validation Events**, which may include:

- approvals
- rejections
- overrides
- escalations
- confirmations
- dispute resolutions

Different financing-participant roles may have different authority levels. For example:

- an underwriter may approve or reject a requirement category;
- a senior underwriter may authorize a substitute document;
- a funding officer may authorize execution;
- a compliance officer may authorize a non-standard acceptance path;
- a supervisor may authorize an override of a discrepancy.

All validation events are logged with:

- identity of the actor
- timestamp
- transaction record identifier
- rationale
- affected requirement category or document
- resulting state or condition

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11. MATERIAL AND NON-MATERIAL CHANGE CONTROL

The platform distinguishes between **material** and **non-material** changes to the transaction. Material changes may include:

- changes to collateral
- changes to customer identity
- changes to financing terms
- changes to jurisdiction
- changes to required disclosures
- changes to ancillary products
- changes to fees or payment schedules

Material changes may require:

- regeneration of the candidate governing contract instrument;
- re-evaluation of requirement categories;
- re-approval by financing participants;
- re-execution of the governing agreement.

Non-material changes may include:

- minor data corrections
- formatting adjustments
- administrative updates

The platform determines whether a change is material and enforces appropriate actions.

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12. PRE-SIGNATURE STABILIZATION

Before execution is authorized, the platform performs **pre-signature stabilization**, which may include:

- verifying that all requirement categories are satisfied;
- confirming that no material changes are pending;
- ensuring that all financing-participant approvals are complete;
- locking the candidate governing contract instrument version;
- generating a final readiness indicator;
- confirming that the transaction is eligible for execution.

Only after stabilization is complete may the transaction enter **Green Stage One**, authorizing execution and funding.

13. EXECUTION, RE-UPLOAD, AND POST-EXECUTION VERIFICATION

Once the transaction reaches **Green Stage One**, execution of the governing agreement is authorized. The platform requires that:

- the governing agreement be executed using the approved candidate governing contract instrument;
- the executed instrument be re-uploaded to the platform;
- the platform verify that the executed instrument corresponds exactly to the approved version;
- the executed instrument be designated as the **source instrument**.

The platform performs **post-execution verification**, which may include:

- signature presence and placement checks;
- page-count verification;
- form-family conformity;
- version matching;
- integrity checks;
- capture-quality evaluation.

If discrepancies are detected, the system may require correction, re-execution, or override authorization.

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14. DISCREPANCY HANDLING, CORRECTION, AND OVERRIDE

The platform includes a **Discrepancy Handling System** that detects:

- missing signatures;
- mismatched versions;
- incomplete pages;
- incorrect form families;
- inconsistent data;
- unacceptable capture quality;
- timing violations;
- missing support records.

When a discrepancy is detected, the system may:

- block advancement;
- generate a discrepancy state;
- require correction;
- require re-upload;
- require re-execution;
- allow an override by an authorized financing participant.

All overrides are logged with:

- identity of the authorizing participant;
- timestamp;
- rationale;
- affected requirement category or document;
- resulting state or condition.

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14A. OVERRIDE EQUIVALENTS AND NON-STANDARD ACCEPTANCE PATHS

The platform supports **override equivalents**, which are controlled acceptance paths for:

- non-standard documents;
- incomplete document sets;
- alternative proofs;
- timing exceptions;
- risk-based exceptions.

Override equivalents may require:

- senior-level approval;

- compliance approval;
- multi-party approval;
- additional documentation;
- additional verification steps.

The platform ensures that override equivalents are used only when authorized and that all such events are logged for audit and review.

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15. SINGLE GOVERNING AGREEMENT ARCHITECTURE

The platform enforces a **single governing agreement architecture**, ensuring that:

- only one operative governing agreement exists for the transaction;
- all embodiments correspond to the same governing agreement;
- the executed source instrument is preserved;
- the authoritative electronic embodiment is used for operational purposes;
- no conflicting or parallel agreements exist.

This architecture eliminates ambiguity and ensures that all participants rely on the same governing agreement.

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15A. AUTHORITY DESIGNATION FUNCTION

The platform includes an **Authority Designation Function** that:

- designates the executed governing contract as the **source instrument**;
- designates the system-certified electronic representation as the **authoritative electronic embodiment**;
- ensures that both embodiments correspond to the same governing agreement;
- prevents unauthorized replacement or alteration of the source instrument;
- ensures that operational use relies on the authoritative electronic embodiment.

The Authority Designation Function ensures consistency, reliability, and evidentiary integrity.

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16. SOURCE INSTRUMENT AND OPERATIONAL AUTHORITY MODEL

The platform uses a **Source Instrument and Operational Authority Model**, in which:

- the executed wet-ink governing contract is the **source instrument**;
- the system-certified electronic representation is the **operational authority**;
- the operational authority is used for storage, retrieval, package generation, audit, legal review, and downstream business operations;
- the source instrument is preserved for evidentiary purposes.

This model ensures that the governing agreement is both preserved and operationally usable.

17. AUTHORITATIVE ELECTRONIC EMBODIMENT

Once the executed governing contract is verified and designated as the **source instrument**, the platform generates a **system-certified authoritative electronic embodiment**. This embodiment:

- corresponds exactly to the same governing agreement as the source instrument;
- is derived from the verified executed instrument;
- is certified by the platform as the operational authority;
- is used for all downstream business operations;
- is protected against unauthorized alteration;
- may include integrity metadata, cryptographic hashes, or audit trails.

The authoritative electronic embodiment ensures that the governing agreement is both operationally accessible and evidentiary-grade.

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17A. ALTERNATIVE DERIVATION AND VALIDATION SOURCES

In some embodiments, the authoritative electronic embodiment may be derived from:

- a digitally executed source instrument;
- a hybrid execution process;
- a multi-part execution process;
- a system-generated composite of multiple executed pages;

- a validated digital representation of a physical source instrument.

The platform ensures that all derivation paths produce an authoritative electronic embodiment that corresponds to the same governing agreement as the source instrument.

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18. SUPPORT RECORD HIERARCHY AND RECORD LINKAGE

The platform maintains a **Support Record Hierarchy** that organizes all non-governing-contract records associated with the transaction. Support records may include:

- disclosures
- proofs
- identity documents
- collateral documents
- ancillary-product documents
- assignment-support documents
- lien-support documents
- filing documents
- risk-based supplemental documents
- correspondence
- approvals
- overrides
- discrepancy records
- timing confirmations
- compliance confirmations

All support records are linked to the **transaction authority file** using a **transaction record identifier**. The platform ensures that:

- all records are associated with the correct transaction;
- all records are preserved in immutable form;
- enhanced or readability-optimized versions may be generated without altering originals;
- all records remain accessible for audit, legal review, and operational use.

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19. ASSIGNMENT AND STANDING SUPPORT LOGIC

The platform includes **Assignment and Standing Support Logic** that ensures:

- the financing participant has the legal right to accept assignment;
- all assignment-supporting documents are present;
- all standing-supporting documents are present;
- all required disclosures have been executed;
- all jurisdiction-specific assignment requirements are satisfied;
- all timing requirements related to assignment are met.

Assignment-supporting documents may include:

- assignment agreements
- dealer agreements
- program agreements
- standing certifications
- collateral filings
- lien-supporting documents
- title applications
- jurisdiction-specific forms

The platform may block funding or assignment until all assignment and standing requirements are satisfied.

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20. SUPPORT DOCUMENT ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

The platform evaluates support documents using **Support Document Acceptance Criteria**, which may include:

- form-family conformity
- jurisdiction-specific requirements
- signature presence and placement
- completeness
- legibility
- capture integrity
- timing compliance
- data consistency
- risk-based criteria
- program-specific criteria

If a support document fails acceptance criteria, the system may:

- reject the document;
- require re-upload;
- require correction;
- require supplemental documentation;
- require financing-participant override.

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21. CAPTURE INTEGRITY AND RENDERING LAYERS

The platform includes a **Capture Integrity Engine** that evaluates:

- resolution
- contrast
- blur
- skew
- cropping
- completeness
- signature detectability
- text detectability
- OCR confidence
- form-family conformity

The platform may generate:

- an immutable original capture;
- a readability-optimized rendering;
- a print-optimized rendering;
- a composite rendering;
- a system-certified rendering.

The platform ensures that enhanced renderings do not replace or alter the immutable original.

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22. IMMUTABILITY, CHAIN OF CUSTODY, AND RETENTION

The platform preserves:

- the executed source instrument;

- the authoritative electronic embodiment;
- all support records;
- all approvals;
- all overrides;
- all discrepancy records;
- all state transitions;
- all timing confirmations;
- all audit trails.

The platform maintains a **chain of custody** for all records, including:

- identity of uploader;
- timestamp;
- device or interface used;
- version history;
- integrity metadata.

Retention rules may include:

- jurisdiction-specific retention requirements;
- financing-participant retention requirements;
- program-specific retention requirements;
- purge rules;
- archival rules.

The platform ensures that records remain accessible for legal, operational, and audit purposes.

23. POST-FUNDING OBLIGATIONS AND CLEARANCE LOGIC

After execution and funding, the platform enters a **post-funding compliance phase**. During this phase, the system tracks all obligations that must be completed before the transaction can be considered fully cleared. These obligations may include:

- title processing
- lien perfection
- filing confirmations
- collateral registration
- jurisdiction-specific post-funding filings
- ancillary-product activation
- insurance verification
- assignment confirmations
- funding reconciliation
- cure of any post-funding discrepancies

The platform monitors completion of each obligation and prevents the transaction from reaching **Green Stage Two** until all required items are satisfied.

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24. POST-FUNDING DISCREPANCY HANDLING

If a discrepancy is discovered after funding, the platform may:

- generate a post-funding discrepancy state;
- require corrective action;
- require supplemental documentation;
- require financing-participant approval;
- require seller correction;
- require jurisdiction-specific cure steps.

Examples of post-funding discrepancies include:

- incorrect lienholder information;
- missing filing confirmations;
- incorrect collateral data;
- incomplete ancillary-product documentation;
- timing violations;
- missing signatures on post-funding forms.

The platform ensures that all post-funding discrepancies are resolved before final clearance.

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25. GREEN STAGE TWO AND FINAL CLEARANCE

A transaction enters **Green Stage Two** only after:

- all post-funding obligations are satisfied;
- all discrepancy states are resolved;
- all required filings are confirmed;
- all assignment and standing requirements are complete;
- all support records are present and validated;
- all timing requirements are met.

Green Stage Two represents **final clearance**, meaning the transaction is fully compliant, fully documented, and ready for long-term retention, audit, or downstream portfolio operations.

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26. PARTICIPANT REVIEW, AUDIT, AND PACKAGE GENERATION

The platform includes a **Participant Review Engine** that allows authorized users to generate:

- audit packages
- legal review packages
- customer delivery packages
- assignment packages
- pooling packages
- compliance packages
- litigation-hold packages
- integrity-proofed packages

Packages may include:

- the authoritative electronic embodiment;
- the executed source instrument;
- all support records;
- all approvals and overrides;
- all discrepancy records;
- all state transitions;
- all timing confirmations;
- all chain-of-custody metadata.

The platform ensures that packages are complete, consistent, and evidentiary-grade.

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27. LITIGATION HOLD, FREEZE, AND RESTRICTION CONTROLS

The platform supports **litigation hold** and **freeze controls**, which may:

- prevent deletion or purge of records;
- prevent modification of metadata;
- restrict access to certain participants;

- preserve all versions of documents;
- preserve all audit trails;
- preserve all state transitions;
- preserve all discrepancy and override records.

Litigation holds may be triggered by:

- legal disputes;
- regulatory inquiries;
- internal investigations;
- compliance reviews;
- portfolio-level events.

The platform ensures that all relevant records remain preserved and accessible during the hold period.

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28. RETENTION, ARCHIVAL, PURGE, AND RESIDUAL FOOTPRINTS

The platform includes **Retention and Purge Logic** that:

- enforces jurisdiction-specific retention rules;
- enforces financing-participant retention rules;
- enforces program-specific retention rules;
- supports archival of inactive transactions;
- supports purge of eligible records;
- preserves residual footprints after purge.

Residual footprints may include:

- transaction record identifier;
- retention metadata;
- purge metadata;
- non-content audit trails;
- compliance confirmations.

Residual footprints ensure that the system maintains a record of the transaction's existence even after content is purged, supporting compliance, audit, and portfolio-level reporting.

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29. WORKFLOW SELF-EVALUATION AND ADAPTIVE IMPROVEMENT

The platform includes a **Workflow Self-Evaluation Engine** that continuously analyzes:

- transaction patterns
- discrepancy frequency
- override frequency
- timing violations
- document-quality issues
- participant behavior
- jurisdiction-specific bottlenecks
- program-specific bottlenecks

Based on these analyses, the system may:

- adjust requirement categories;
- adjust timing rules;
- adjust workflow instructions;
- adjust document equivalency rules;
- recommend training;
- recommend process improvements;
- generate alerts for systemic issues.

The platform may also use machine-learning models to predict:

- likely discrepancies;
- likely missing documents;
- likely timing violations;
- likely approval delays;
- likely post-funding issues.

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30. ANALYTICS, REPORTING, AND PORTFOLIO-LEVEL INSIGHTS

The platform includes an **Analytics and Reporting Engine** that generates:

- operational reports
- compliance reports
- discrepancy reports

- override reports
- timing reports
- funding reports
- assignment reports
- portfolio-level summaries
- jurisdiction-specific analytics
- program-specific analytics

Portfolio-level insights may include:

- risk indicators
- document-quality trends
- workflow efficiency metrics
- participant performance metrics
- exception-path frequency
- post-funding cure rates

These insights support continuous improvement and portfolio-level decision-making.

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31. MULTI-PARTY INTERACTION AND CONTROLLED COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

The platform supports controlled communication channels between:

- sellers
- financing participants
- administrative personnel
- auditors
- legal reviewers

Communications may include:

- discrepancy notices
- approval requests
- override requests
- clarification requests
- document requests
- timing alerts
- compliance alerts

All communications are logged and linked to the transaction authority file.

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32. DEVICE-ASSISTED CAPTURE AND OPTIONAL HARDWARE INTEGRATION

The platform may integrate with:

- mobile devices
- tablets
- dedicated capture devices
- scanners
- signature pads
- biometric devices

Device-assisted capture may include:

- guided capture workflows
- real-time quality evaluation
- automatic cropping
- automatic alignment
- automatic enhancement
- signature detection
- form-family detection

The platform ensures that device-assisted capture produces evidentiary-grade records.

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33. SECURITY, ACCESS CONTROL, AND IDENTITY MANAGEMENT

The platform includes:

- multi-factor authentication
- role-based access control
- encryption at rest
- encryption in transit
- device-level security
- IP-based restrictions
- jurisdiction-specific data-handling rules

- audit logging
- anomaly detection

Identity management may include:

- user identity verification
- device identity verification
- session management
- access-revocation controls

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34. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE AND DISTRIBUTED IMPLEMENTATION

The platform may be implemented as:

- a cloud-based system
- a distributed system
- a hybrid system
- a microservices architecture
- a containerized environment

Components may include:

- application servers
- database servers
- document-storage systems
- rendering engines
- analytics engines
- workflow engines
- integration gateways

The system may integrate with:

- financing-participant systems
- dealer management systems
- filing systems
- collateral registries
- identity-verification systems
- payment systems

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35. ALTERNATIVE EMBODIMENTS AND SCOPE

Alternative embodiments may include:

- digital-only execution workflows
- hybrid execution workflows
- multi-jurisdictional workflows
- multi-party financing workflows
- blockchain-based integrity layers
- AI-assisted discrepancy detection
- AI-assisted document classification
- jurisdiction-specific variants
- program-specific variants

The invention is not limited to the embodiments described herein. Variations, modifications, and equivalents are within the scope of the claims.

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CLAIMS

1. A computer-implemented transaction authority system configured to govern the formation, validation, execution, preservation, and post-funding clearance of financed transactions, the system comprising:
a transaction intake engine;
a form synthesis engine;
a candidate evaluation engine;
a requirement satisfaction engine;
a financing-participant validation engine;
a state machine engine;
a capture integrity engine;
a source lock engine;
an authoritative embodiment engine;
a support record engine; and
a post-funding compliance engine;
wherein the system enforces a single governing agreement architecture and controls all state transitions based on satisfaction of predefined conditions.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the system generates a candidate governing contract instrument and evaluates the instrument before execution.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the system designates an executed governing contract as a source instrument and generates a system-certified authoritative electronic embodiment corresponding to the same governing agreement.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the system enforces role-based workflow segmentation and differential authority for financing-participant approvals, overrides, and discrepancy handling.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein the system tracks post-funding obligations and transitions the transaction to a final clearance state only after all obligations are satisfied.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein the system maintains a support record hierarchy linking all support records to a transaction authority file using a transaction record identifier.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein the system includes a discrepancy handling engine configured to detect, classify, and manage discrepancies before and after execution.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the system includes a workflow self-evaluation engine configured to analyze transaction patterns and recommend workflow improvements.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the system includes a participant review engine configured to generate evidentiary-grade record packages.

10. A method for forming, validating, executing, and clearing a financed transaction, comprising:
generating a candidate governing contract instrument;
evaluating the candidate instrument;
assigning a transaction state;
generating a completion protocol;
satisfying requirement categories;
authorizing execution;
verifying the executed governing contract;
designating the executed contract as a source instrument;
generating an authoritative electronic embodiment;
linking support records to a transaction authority file; and
completing post-funding obligations.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising enforcing a single governing agreement architecture.

12. The method of claim 10, further comprising generating a system-certified authoritative electronic embodiment corresponding to the same governing agreement as the source instrument.

13. The method of claim 10, further comprising enforcing role-based workflow segmentation.

14. The method of claim 10, further comprising generating evidentiary-grade record packages.

15. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause a system to perform the method of any of claims 10–14.